

NUMBER DETECTIVES

My First Sudoku

1 2 3 4

Session 1: Solving the 4x4 Puzzle

MEET THE GRID!

What is a Grid?

A grid is a big square made of smaller squares called **Khali jagah** (empty spaces).

The Story of the Mela:

Imagine a stall at a bazaar or mela. Every shelf must have different toys so everyone can see something new! In Sudoku, our "toys" are numbers or fruits.

Our Fruit Friends:

Before we use numbers, let's meet our 4 fruit friends who each need their own square:

 **Mango**,  **Guava**,  **Banana**, and  **Papaya**

It's like friends waiting for their turn on the swing — everyone wants a turn, but only one can sit at a time!

THE ONE RULE: NO REPEATS!

To be a true **Jasoos (Detective)**, you must remember the most important rule in Sudoku:

"If Mango is here, no other Mango can be in this row or column! Right or Wrong?"

Spot the Mistake!

Look carefully at a row. If you see two Mangoes, that is **Wrong!** A detective's job is to scan each row and column to fix these repeats.



How to Scan:

- 👉 Look left-to-right (Row).
- 👉 Look top-to-bottom (Column).
- 👉 Ask yourself: *"Is my friend already here?"*

DIRA THE JASOOS

Let's watch how Dira solves a puzzle. She scans each row carefully to find where the missing friends belong.

Scanning Step-by-Step:

1 Scan: Dira looks at a row and sees: *Mango... Guava... Banana...*

2 Identify: She asks, *"Hmm, who is missing?"*

3 Found! *"Papaya! Papaya goes in the Empty space!"*

"I scan each row like a Jasoos!" says Dira. Can you spot the empty space?

Check! → Scan.. → Found!

THE BLOCK CHALLENGE

Looking Inside the 2x2 Boxes

Inside our big 4x4 grid, there are 4 smaller squares. We call these **2x2** blocks.

"Each little box is like a small stall in the bazaar — no repeats allowed inside!"

Each **2x2** block must have all 4 friends — Mango, Guava, Banana, and Papaya — with no repeating!

The Block Scan:

Look at a **2x2** block. If you have Mango, Guava, and Banana... who is missing? Use your detective skills to find the missing friend and fill the stall!

YOU ARE A NUMBER DETECTIVE!

🎉 Congratulations! You filled the grid like a real Jasoos. 🎉

What We Learned Today:

- 🔍 How to find repeated friends and fix them.
- 🔍 How to scan rows and columns for missing pieces.
- 🔍 How to complete the 2×2 Block Challenge.

Next Time: We'll try even bigger 6x6 puzzles! Keep practicing your detective skills.

Thank You, Number Detectives!

"Ask questions, solve more puzzles, and become a Sudoku master!"